

Total turkeys

For every high-flying GENIUS invention, there are countless other ones that never make it OFF THE GROUND.

1801 Captain Dick's Puffer

British inventor **RICHARD TREVITHICK** lost his train of thought when he left the engine of *his first passenger steam carriage* running while he stopped off for a quick drink. All the water in the engine boiled off and poor old Captain Dick's Puffer **exploded**. But Trevithick got back on track two years later with his celebrated creation, the steam locomotive.

1862 Hunley's submarine

American engineer Horace Hunley had that sinking feeling when his submarine came to a disastrous end during the the **Civil War**. The underwater weapon had been developed from an old boiler and was **ARMED WITH A TORPEDO**. Hunley's design managed to sink an enemy ship, but the sub itself exploded at the same time, and joined its target *on the seabed*.

1874 De Groof parachute

With his eyes firmly on the skies, Belgian Vincent De Groof longed to fly like a bird. His vision came to life with a **WINGED PARACHUTE** that he *attached to a balloon* to soar over London. When the wings fell apart midflight, the birdbrain's feathers were **truly ruffled**. In a flap, he hit the ground, ending his dream and his life.

1880s Suitcase life jacket

A German named Krankel built a case for a life jacket—literally. His suitcase had two removable panels just *in case of an emergency*. Wearers took out the panels, blocked the hole with a rubber ring, and wriggled into the case. But **carrying excess baggage** didn't float everyone's boat and the invention quickly moved **FROM SUITCASE TO NUTCASE**.

1894 Maxim's flying machine

American-born innovator **HIRAM MAXIM** fired his way to success with the machine gun in 1884, but he crashed with his attempt at a **flying machine**. Despite five sets of wings spanning 125 ft (38 m), two steam engines, and a pair of propellers, the machine took off from rails and flew briefly before coming back down to earth with *a very big bump!*

The mechanism worked best with dome-shaped bowler hats.

1896 Self-raising hat

Back in Victorian times, it was all the rage for gentlemen to *tip their hats* when passing ladies on the street. Hats off, then, to American **JAMES BOYLE**, who made mechanics do the hard work with his self-tipping hat. When the wearer **gave the nod**, a clockwork device inside tipped the hat to the passing lady. Sadly for Boyle, the hat simply failed to raise the interest of customers, and it was hung up for good soon after.



1896 Power shower

A lean machine for **KEEPING CLEAN** was the brainchild of one particularly eager cyclist. It was basically a bicycle (without wheels) that used **pedal power** to pump water in the shower. The more pedaling, the stronger the power shower. Great for gym rats, but *not so easy for couch potatoes*. "You're all wet!" was the general response to this fleeting fad.